



Down Payment Assistance *Guide*

How assistance programs
may help reduce
upfront costs —
with an **Arizona** focus.



INSIDE THIS GUIDE



What DPA is, program types, common eligibility factors, what it may cover, and the questions to ask before you rely on a program.



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UPFRONT
COSTS



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What Down Payment Assistance Is

DPA refers to programs that may help eligible buyers reduce the money needed upfront.

- 1 May help with upfront funds**
Some programs may assist with down payment, closing costs, or both, depending on program rules.
- 2 Eligibility is required**
Income, location, credit, loan type, property type, and buyer education may all matter.
- 3 Programs vary**
Rules can change by state, county, city, lender, investor, and funding availability.
- 4 It is not guaranteed**
Don't rely on assistance until eligibility and availability are confirmed.

CAREFUL WORDING MATTERS Assistance may help qualified buyers, but no guide can promise approval, eligibility, availability, or a specific benefit.

Grants vs. Second Loans vs. Forgivable Help

The label matters less than the repayment terms, eligibility rules, and how the program fits your full loan strategy.

GRANT **May not require repayment**
Ask whether it's truly a grant, whether tax reporting applies, and what conditions must be met.

2ND LOAN **May be a separate loan**
Ask about payments, interest, due-on-sale terms, refinance rules, and how it affects approval.

FORGIV. **May be forgiven over time**
Ask how forgiveness works, what happens if you sell or refinance, and what could trigger repayment.

BOTTOM LINE Don't compare programs only by the dollar amount. Compare the rules, repayment terms, timeline, and total fit.

Common Eligibility Factors

DPA programs are not universal — you may match one program and not another, even in the same market.

Income limits

Many programs use household income or area median income limits.

Location

Programs may be tied to a state, county, city, or targeted area.

Property type

Single-family, condo, manufactured, and multi-unit rules may differ.

Loan type

FHA, conventional, VA, USDA, and bond programs may each have different rules.

Credit and debt

Minimum scores, debt-to-income limits, and underwriting rules may apply.

Education

Homebuyer education or counseling may be required before closing.

ARIZONA NOTE In Arizona, ask your loan team which current statewide and city/county programs you may qualify for. Availability, funding, and rules change — nothing here is a guarantee of assistance.

What Assistance Can and Cannot Cover

May help with	May not cover
Down payment	Every buyer or every property
Some closing costs	Cash reserves after closing
Prepaid items, if allowed	Debt payoff unless allowed
Required buyer education costs (rarely)	Repairs or personal purchases
Other allowable costs by program	Costs above program caps

BUYER MINDSET Think of DPA as one possible tool, not the whole plan. Understand the total cost picture first, then see whether assistance may fit.

Before You Rely on a Program

The right questions can prevent surprises later.

- 1 Am I eligible based on income, location, credit, and loan type?
- 2 Is funding currently available, and how long does approval take?
- 3 Is this a grant, a second loan, or forgivable assistance?
- 4 What can the funds be used for, and what cannot be covered?
- 5 What happens if I sell, refinance, move out, or pay off the loan early?
- 6 Can this be combined with seller credits or other assistance?
- 7 Are there education, inspection, property, or occupancy requirements?

Let's create your plan together.

Schedule your free strategy call at movewithmaryv.com

Know your home. Plan your next move.

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